

### Lover's Rock - Dance Scene Camera Movements

In the 2020 dramatic romance movie "Lover's Rock", during the dance scene, the camera begins zoomed into the record player, completely steady, focused on the needle as it is slowly lowered down onto the record. The camera stays on the record player for about a beat and a half, just long enough to notice it has overstayed its welcome before we rapidly cut to hands slapping and hitting the walls. As the camera continues to cut, the steady cam becomes more and more unsteady until we cut to a smooth camera tracking a couple as they walk around a group in the center of the room.

The next few cuts occur when the music begins to pick up. Where the camera is no longer at the breast level and is now looking up at the crowd from leg height. Again, we see the same pattern as we did before, where the camera is completely stationary until it looks like it has been picked up and transformed into a hand-cam in the center of the crowd. This, I believe, is done to move the audience into the crowd as one of the partygoers.

After establishing the camera's presence in the crowd, we cut to various characters around the room, where they are very clearly the focus. This does well to prime the audience to these characters in their mind before their role in the scene becomes apparent.

Next, we see the crowd move from the center of the room to the DJ in the corner. In order to enhance this, the camera takes a one-shot journey from the center of the crowd, smoothly moving around to the DJ. The framing of the shot has the crowd on the left reaching toward the DJ on the right. The camera is then put in place where it swings constantly and smoothly from the crowd on the left and the DJ on the right as if you would move your head back and forth. This sequence is broken when the focus is placed on the record player as the DJ spins it.

In the next sequence, the camera moves back into the fray of the crowd. Focus is clearly placed on characters as they dance and move to the music. We notice that this is the longest unbroken sequence in the entire scene. As the crowd becomes more and more chaotic, the movement of the camera also becomes more chaotic. Then, we cut back to the leg height. The camera is no longer chaotic and becomes steady once again. The rest of this sequence, the camera is moving from chest height to leg height and vice versa.

This pattern continues until we cut to the DJ, where we focus steadily on his hands as he turns down the music on his machine. This cut is similar to the very first part of this

scene, where the camera is zoomed in and has a very narrow field of focus. Then finally, the last sequence is another unbroken movement through the crowd without much regard for personal space. It comes in close into one characters face and pulls back to show the crowd shouting and raising their fists with the DJ.

## Lover's Rock - Sound Components

### Dialogue:

The majority of the narrative of the film is told through dialogue. All of the dialogue in this film is very realistic and natural. There is no extreme emotion or drama in the dialogue like you would see in a movie like The Avengers or a TV show like Game of Thrones. Instead, the dialogue has a different purpose; the way that characters talk to each other shows their relationship with each other without having to directly tell the audience.

### Music:

Music in Lovers Rock is integral to the atmosphere of the film. As the emotion of the film changes between scenes, the score also changes to fit the emotions. I also notice that all of the music in the film is diegetic; in fact, all of the sound in the film is diegetic. We also see that when the film needs to focus on dialogue or other elements in a scene, the music is pulled away from the audience typically by having characters move to another room or for the music to simply lose volume.

### Sound Effects:

Lastly, the sound effects in the movie are all background elements in the story. The sound effects only exist to sell the elements in a scene, there isn't a scene where a sound effect takes over the focus like you would see in an action movie with a large explosion. In a scene, the sound effects are presented to the audience in service to the story and plot. For example, in a scene where a specific element is being used, sound effects are used to focus on this element. There is a scene where 2 characters are sitting on a couch with a plastic cover. Sound effects are used to focus on the character as he gets up from the seat.